



in early spring. Mulch around the base of trees for the first few years with well-rotted manure, compost, or bark, to suppress weeds and keep the soil moist.

HARVESTING AND STORING

Most nuts will be ready for harvesting in fall. If you leave them on the tree too long you risk that they will be stolen by squirrels or, in the case of walnuts, birds. Clean and dry the harvested nuts thoroughly. Store them in a cool, dark place, ensuring that no rats or mice can get to them. A net bag is ideal, as it will ensure airy conditions.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Walnuts are generally problem-free, but may come under attack from walnut leaf blight and walnut blotch, which cause black and brown spots on leaves and fruits. Remove and destroy any diseased plant material.

Cobnuts may become infected with powdery mildew—remove and destroy leaves and spray the tree with fungicide. Treat almonds as for peaches and nectarines. The biggest threat to other nut trees will probably be squirrels, so net wherever possible, and if space allows, create a wire mesh fruit cage around trees.